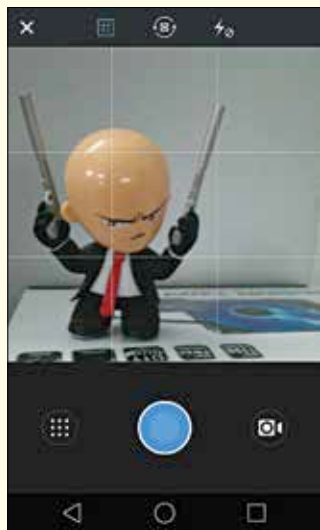




skills, build followers and gain a number of bragging rights. Below are a few tips and tricks you may not yet know about. We hope they help you tell a better story with your photographs.

Use Rule of Thirds feature to take better pictures

While clicking pictures, amateur photographers are usually at their wit's end about where in the frame to place the subject so as to get the most aesthetically pleasing photo. To help you with the positioning of your subject, the Rule of Thirds toggle button comes in handy. The button shows up when you open the camera. Pressing the button will give you a grid. Let this grid



guide you in placing important compositional elements along these lines or their intersections. A little research on the photography principle of "rule of thirds" will go a long way in helping you take amazing pictures of any object, scenery or person.

Create collages

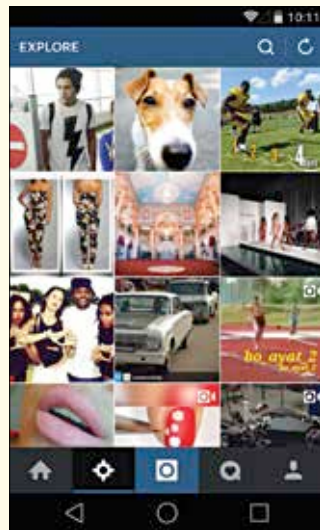
Multiple images strewn about in one picture look interesting, but Instagram doesn't give you any default options to create collages. For this, you'll need to install third-party apps such as PicsArt, Photo Grid and

Pic Stitch. These apps will help you create photo montages using different layouts and grids. Once you're satisfied with the results, you can then upload your collages to Instagram.

Get more followers

Every time you upload pictures, be it of every single food you eat or the hordes of selfies you take, you may be loath to admit that it was an attempt to gain more followers. A healthy way to get more followers would be to engage with other Instagrammers with similar interests by commenting on and/or liking their photos. Click the Explore tab to find others like you.

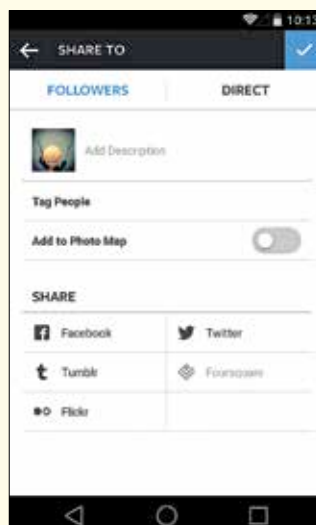
Also, don't forget to write a descriptive bio in your profile to



intrigue users into following you back. You can also score more viewers by sharing your images on other social networks.

Save photos without having to upload

Say you want to add the Instagram filters to your photos, but don't want to upload them to your profile. Once you're done editing and adding the desired filters, move on to the next section where you're asked to add a caption and upload the image. At this point after the image has



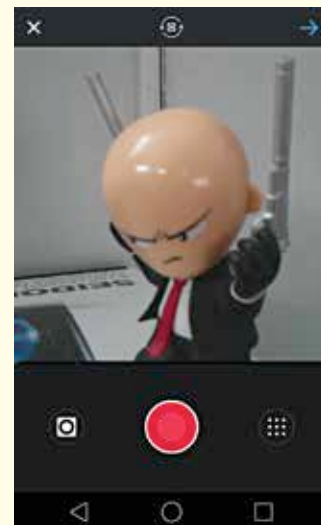
finished processing, you can rest assured that it has been saved in a separate folder. Alternatively, you could do the whole uploading process with the Airplane Mode switched on. Since the mode switches off Internet, you'll get a failed notification after uploading. Your edited image can be found in your album.

Go beyond Instagram's editing capabilities

Sometimes, even the current 20 filters and editing options in Instagram fall short of the desired effect we're looking for. So to overcome the limitation, we could use other photo editing apps such as Snapseed and Pixlr Express to add much more effects like textures and patterns, and even text to your pictures. Apps like InstaSize give you the option of resizing your image if it doesn't meet Instagram's 1:1 aspect ratio limit.

Record "stop motion" videos

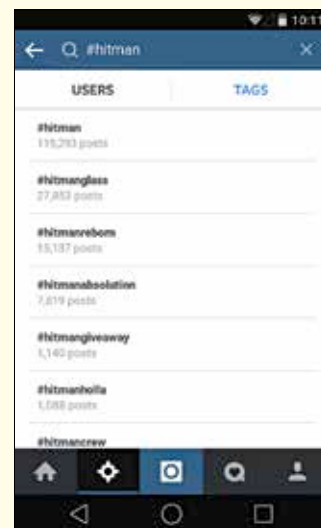
You can record up to 15 seconds of video by pressing and holding the record button. An amazing feature is the ability to record videos in segments under different frames. Leaving the record button pauses the video, so you could move on to a different frame. The final video would



include several scenes stitched together and some play-pause video magic right from your smartphone. Technically, this isn't stop motion, but close to the effect we're aiming for.

Use hashtags correctly

Many users of hashtags either don't know how to use them or simply love flooding their photos



with unnecessary tags. Hashtags actually increase the discoverability of your photo. Relevant and meaningful tags give it more visibility, comments and likes. Take a look at the most popular hashtags trending at <http://web.stagram.com/hot/>. Note that Instagram limits the number of hashtags to 30.